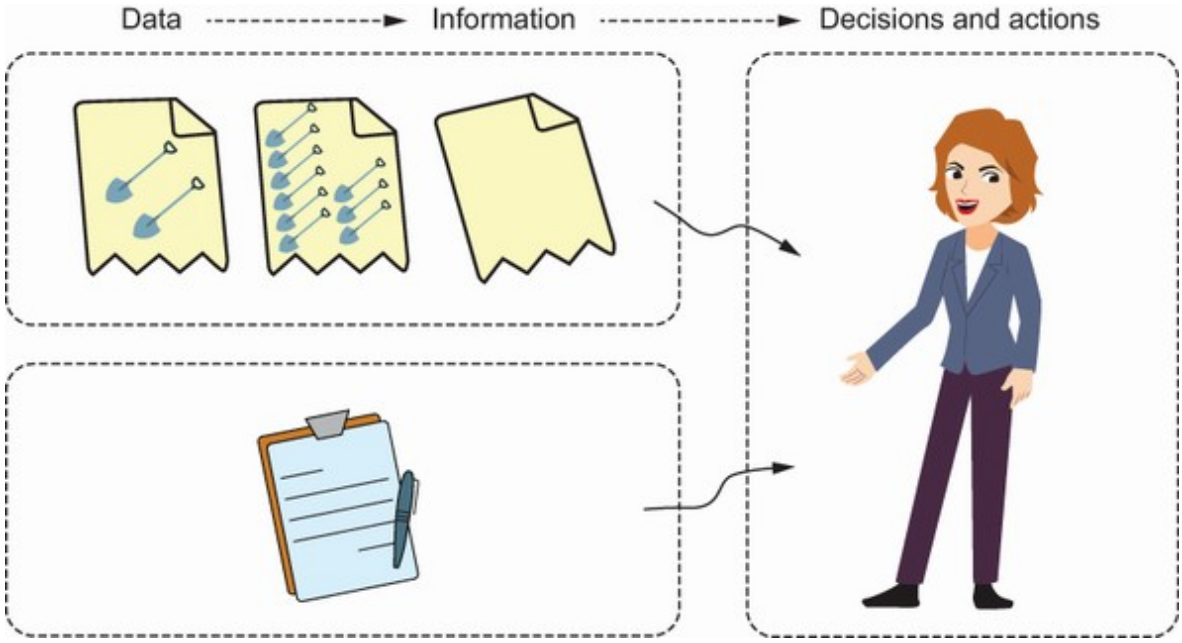


Figure 1.8 Decentralized data provisioning in Adam's and Eve's domains served to Bob for decision-making

In our data flow, Adam and Eve now keep both data and information in their domains. They try to supply Bob with a proper set of *information*, not just the raw data they were asked to collect, so he can make the procurement decisions. Bob seems much happier. When asked by Candace why this is so, he tells her that Eve realized that he also needs to know how often shovels break. Eve breaks them more often because of the longer driveways.

An unexpected business benefit of shortening the data flow emerges. In the past, Adam and Eve usually presented Candace with pessimistic approximations because they did not want to be left without shovels. Sometimes they were afraid of her reaction to too many broken shovels, so hoping for the best, they presented her with optimistic estimates. Candace usually added an extra *safety margin* before sending the order to Bob, but sometimes she got worried about spending and took a risk of lowering the received estimation.

Bob, knowing that the numbers he received were unreliable, often tried to adjust the order based on his gut feeling (and telling Candace, that, e.g., the required numbers of shovels was not available on the market). To keep the company running, he had to create a buffer of shovels, and this decreased the